Colour theory

National 5 · Design & DTP · Worksheet

GRAPHICS WITH MR KELLY

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

By the end of this worksheet I can…
- ☐ identify primary, secondary and tertiary colours
- ☐ explain warm, cool, advancing, receding, harmony, contrast, tints, shades and mood

I DO — Worked example

Read how a full-mark answer is built

A designer lightens a purple background for a children's leaflet.

1 State what is added to create a tint, and name two tertiary colours. (3 marks)

Points that earn marks from the marking instructions: one ✓ per point
- ✓ Add white
- ✓ Any two tertiary colours, e.g. red-orange, red-violet, yellow-green, blue-green

WE DO — Guided practice

Use the starters and word bank to help you

A poster uses a red "SALE" banner on a blue background.

2 Explain why red was chosen for the banner. (1 mark)

Sentence starters
One reason is … because …
Another reason is … so …

Word bank
forward · stands · advancing · colour · background · banner · contrasts

Tip: 1 marks = 1 separate, developed points.

YOU DO — On your own

No notes. Check your answers afterwards.

3 Quick check: tick one box for each.

a) Red and green are…
☐ Harmonious ☐ Contrasting (complementary) ☐ Both cool ☐ Tertiary

b) Blue, blue-green and green together are…
☐ Contrasting ☐ Harmonious ☐ Warm ☐ Primary

c) To make a tint you add…
☐ Black ☐ Grey ☐ White ☐ The complementary colour

d) Which is a tertiary colour?
☐ Green ☐ Red-orange ☐ Blue ☐ Purple

4 Key terms: write the letter of the matching description next to each term.

1. **Primary colours**	____	**A** A primary mixed with a neighbouring secondary, e.g. red-orange.
2. **Secondary colours**	____	**B** A colour with black added.
3. **Tertiary colour**	____	**C** Red, yellow, blue.
4. **Tint**	____	**D** Warm colours that seem to come forward.
5. **Shade**	____	**E** A colour with white added.
6. **Advancing colours**	____	**F** Orange, green, purple.

5 Explain what is meant by ‘Receding colours’. (2 marks)

6 Explain what is meant by ‘Harmonious colours’. (2 marks)

7 Explain what is meant by ‘Contrasting colours’. (2 marks)

Check and reflect
Mark your answers with the answer sheet. Go back to the checklist on the site and re-rate each “I can” statement above. Which one still needs work?